

Latest News Stories

WHO Declares Global Health Emergency as Rare Ebola Strain Crosses from Congo into Uganda

The World Health Organization declared an Ebola outbreak in the Democratic Republic of Congo and neighbouring Uganda a “public health emergency of international concern” on Sunday, after more than 300 suspected cases and 88 deaths were recorded. The declaration, the WHO’s second-highest alert level, stops short of classifying the situation as a pandemic emergency.

The outbreak originates in eastern DRC’s Ituri province and involves the rare Bundibugyo strain of Ebola — a variant for which no approved vaccine or treatment exists. This is the DRC’s 17th Ebola outbreak since the virus was first identified there in 1976, and only the third time the Bundibugyo strain has been detected anywhere in the world.

The outbreak began in Mongwalu, a busy mining area, where infected people later travelled out, sought treatment in other locations, and spread the disease further. Health authorities say the patient zero was a nurse. The Africa Centres for Disease Control and Prevention said the earliest known suspected case developed symptoms on April 24 and died at a hospital in Ituri on April 27. By the time health authorities were alerted to the outbreak via social media on May 5, 50 deaths had already been recorded.

As of May 16, eight laboratory-confirmed cases, 246 suspected cases, and 80 suspected deaths had been reported in Ituri Province across at least three health zones, including Bunia, Rwampara, and Mongwalu. In the eastern DRC city of Goma, at least one Ebola case has been identified, according to a spokesperson for the Rwanda-backed AFC/M23 rebel coalition. The virus has already crossed international borders. In Uganda, two laboratory-confirmed cases — including one death — have been reported in the capital, Kampala. The two cases had no apparent

link to each other, but both individuals had travelled from the DRC. A laboratory-confirmed case has also been reported in Congo’s capital, Kinshasa, around 1,000 kilometres from the outbreak’s epicentre in Ituri, suggesting possible wider spread.

The identification of a non-Zaire variant will complicate the response, as existing treatments and vaccines were developed against the Zaire strain. With 87 deaths among 246 suspected cases, the current case fatality rate exceeds 35 percent — consistent with historical Bundibugyo outbreaks.

Africa CDC warned that population movements, weak healthcare infrastructure, and violence by armed groups in Ituri could complicate containment efforts. The WHO has released emergency funds to support surveillance, contact tracing, and clinical care, and WHO Director-General Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus praised both governments for their “frankness” in assessing the risk posed to other nations.

Thank you for reading, and supporting the ICS Journalism Club.

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School Newspaper Bringing Science, History, and a New Latest News Stories Section to Readers



Welcome to the latest issue of our school newspaper! In this edition, we explore a variety of topics from science, history, and current events. Readers can learn about Einstein’s famous Twin Paradox, discover how the Ottoman Empire used balance policies to survive in the 19th century, and enjoy other interesting articles prepared by our writers.

We are also proud to introduce our new “Latest News Stories” section, where readers can find short updates on important events happening around the world. Alongside school news and feature stories, this new section aims to make our newspaper more informative and engaging for everyone.

The Twin Paradox Explained

Einstein’s “Twin Paradox” explains how time can pass differently for people moving at very high speeds. In the example, one twin stays on Earth while the other travels through space near the speed of light. When the traveler returns, they are younger because time moved more slowly for them, an effect called time dilation. Though confusing at first, the idea has been proven through real scientific experiments and is an important part of modern physics.

Read more on page 2.

Ottoman Empire’s Struggle for Survival

In the 19th century, the Ottoman Empire grew weaker due to economic problems, nationalist rebellions, and pressure from powerful European states such as Russia, Britain, and France. To protect itself, the empire followed a “balance policy,” gaining support from one power against another. This was seen during the Crimean War, when the Ottomans allied with Britain and France against Russia. Although this strategy delayed the empire’s collapse, it also increased dependence on Europe and could not restore Ottoman strength.

Read more on page 3.

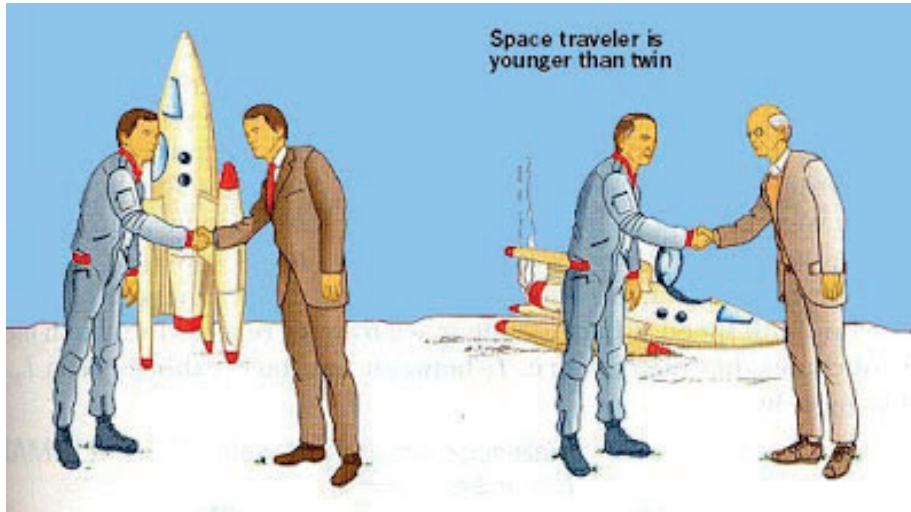
Latest Global News Roundup

World leaders continue to respond to rising global tensions as economic concerns and regional conflicts dominate international headlines. Scientists have also reported new advances in space and technology research, while major cities around the world face challenges linked to climate change and extreme weather. Meanwhile, sports and entertainment events have attracted global attention, providing moments of celebration amid a busy week of breaking news.

Read more on pages 4 & beyond.

The Twin Paradox

by Cengizhan Düzakman



The Twin Paradox is a famous idea from Einstein's theory of relativity. It helps us understand how time can pass differently for people who are moving at very high speeds.

After some time, the traveling twin returns to Earth. When they meet again, something surprising happens: the twin who traveled in space is younger than the twin who stayed on Earth.

The Basic Idea

Imagine two twins: one stays on Earth, and the other travels into space in a very fast spaceship. The spaceship moves close to the speed of light, which is extremely fast.

Why Does This Happen?

According to Einstein's theory, time slows down for objects that move very fast. This effect is called time dilation.

For the twin in the spaceship, time moves more slowly compared to the twin on Earth. So even though both twins feel normal time passing, less time has actually passed for the traveling twin.

Why Is It Called a Paradox?

It is called a 'paradox' because it seems confusing at first. You might think that each twin should see the other as moving, so both should age less. But the key difference is that the traveling twin changes direction and returns to Earth, while the Earth twin does not. This breaks the symmetry and explains why only one twin is younger.

Conclusion

The Twin Paradox shows that time is not the same for everyone. It depends on how fast you are moving. This idea has been tested in real experiments and is an important part of modern physics.

Izmir Weather Forecast

for this week (Monday 18th - Sunday 24th)

Monday should be sunny and pleasantly warm, with temperatures reaching the **mid-20s °C** and cooler conditions overnight. Tuesday looks slightly warmer and more humid, with more cloud cover moving in but still generally comfortable. Wednesday is expected to stay mild with a mix of sun and clouds and little chance of rain.

By Thursday, there's a higher

possibility of afternoon showers developing, though much of the day should still be partly sunny. Friday continues that pattern with increasing clouds and scattered showers later in the day. Saturday currently looks like the wettest day of the week, with periods of rain expected and slightly cooler daytime temperatures.

Sunday should improve compared to Saturday, with a few showers

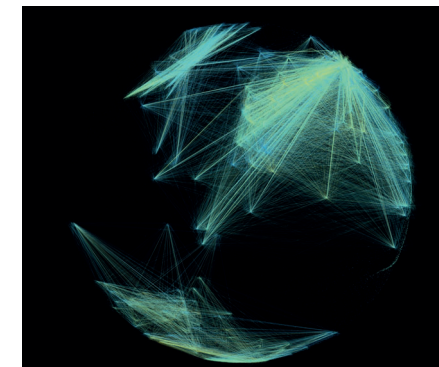
possible in the morning followed by breaks of sunshine later in the day. Early next week, conditions appear to become warmer and drier again, with sunshine returning and temperatures climbing back into the **mid-to-upper 20s °C** range.

This week in Izmir should feel mostly like classic late-spring Mediterranean weather: warm afternoons, mild evenings, and plenty of sunshine overall.

Latest News Stories

AI Investment Boom Reshapes Global Economy Amid Rising Competition

Artificial intelligence has become the defining economic story of 2026, with governments and technology companies accelerating investments at a pace analysts describe as unprecedented. Major firms are pouring billions into data centers, semiconductor production, and advanced AI systems as competition between the United States, China, and Europe intensifies.



Technology companies are increasingly positioning AI not merely as a digital tool but as a foundation for future economic growth. Market analysts say the surge in spending has helped financial markets remain stable despite ongoing geopolitical tensions and energy concerns. Investors continue to treat AI as the central engine of future productivity, especially in industries such as healthcare, logistics, education, and finance.

The spotlight has particularly focused on semiconductor

giant Nvidia, whose enormous investment commitments have become symbolic of the wider AI race. Industry observers are closely watching the company's latest earnings reports for clues about how sustainable the global AI spending boom may be. Analysts argue that AI infrastructure now plays a role similar to railroads during the Industrial Revolution or the internet during the late 1990s technology boom.



At the same time, concerns over regulation and ethics continue to grow. International organizations and policy experts warn that AI development is moving faster than governments can regulate it. Discussions at major economic forums this year have increasingly focused on AI governance, misinformation, and national security. Experts from the Atlantic Council recently warned that artificial intelligence could reshape diplomacy, defense policy, and global power structures more rapidly than previously expected.

One growing concern involves what researchers call "AI poisoning," where false or manipulated information is intentionally spread online to influence future AI systems trained

on internet data. Experts fear this could undermine public trust and distort digital information ecosystems. Governments are now debating how to create international standards for trustworthy AI development without slowing innovation.

The rise of AI has also sparked debate about employment. While supporters argue that AI will create new industries and improve efficiency, critics warn that automation could disrupt millions of jobs. Sectors involving repetitive office tasks are expected to experience the fastest changes. Educational institutions are already adapting by expanding AI-focused training programs and digital literacy initiatives.

Environmental concerns are also emerging. Data centers powering advanced AI systems require massive amounts of electricity and water, raising questions about sustainability. Researchers have warned that countries with weaker technological infrastructure may struggle to benefit equally from AI advances, potentially widening global inequality.

Despite the concerns, global investment momentum shows little sign of slowing. Governments increasingly see AI leadership as essential for economic competitiveness and national influence. As businesses race to integrate machine learning into everyday services, 2026 may be remembered as the year artificial intelligence fully entered the center of global economic and political life.

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international cooperation to prevent economic fragmentation and instability.

Despite these concerns, some economists remain cautiously optimistic. Advances in renewable energy, AI-driven productivity, and global infrastructure investment may help offset some economic risks over the long term. However, experts agree that the coming years will require careful political and economic decision-making as countries navigate an increasingly uncertain global environment.

Bulgaria's Dara Stuns Vienna with Record-Breaking Eurovision Victory

In what is being described as the biggest upset in the competition's 70-year history, Bulgarian pop star Dara claimed the Eurovision Song Contest crown on Saturday night in Vienna with her electrifying dance anthem "Bangaranga," winning with a record-breaking margin of 173 points over second-placed Israel — the largest winning margin ever seen at the Eurovision Song Contest, surpassing Alexander Rybak's famous 169-point lead at the 2009 contest in Moscow.

The win was a significant upset. "Bangaranga" is an upbeat dance-pop number featuring intense choreography and an infectious chorus. The fever-dream of a tune captivated the audience in the Wiener Stadthalle and received



some of the loudest cheers of the evening. Bulgaria won both the national juries, scoring 204 points, and the public televote, scoring 312 — making it the first time in nearly a decade that juries and the public have chosen the same winner.

Until the final public vote was announced it appeared as if Israel's Noam Bettan was set to win the contest. Bettan was loudly cheered — though with a smattering of boos — as he performed "Michelle," a rock ballad in Hebrew, French, and English about learning to leave a toxic relationship behind. Romania's Alexandra Căpitănescu came third with the provocatively titled rock song "Choke Me," while Australian star Delta Goodrem finished fourth and Italian crooner Sal Da Vinci fifth.

The win marked Bulgaria's first Eurovision victory since joining the competition in 2005. The country had not sent a performer to the previous three Eurovision

Song Contests and only returned in 2026 as a handful of other countries opted out due to Israel's inclusion. This year's contest was overshadowed by discord and controversy, with five countries withdrawing in a dispute over Israel's continued participation.

Dara is one of the most well-known pop musicians in Bulgaria, with multiple number-one hits on the official Bulgarian Airplay Chart and a presence in the broader Balkan music scene. Her songs and videos have amassed over 80 million listens and views, and she has served as a mentor on The Voice of Bulgaria. She describes "Bangaranga" as expressing "a special energy that everyone has got in themselves — a feeling that everything is possible."

As is tradition, the winning country will host next year's Eurovision Song Contest, meaning Bulgaria will stage the 71st competition in 2027. The 2026 contest was itself held in Vienna after Austria won last year.

The Ottoman Balance Policy

by Yonca Turuşlar (11A)

The 19th century was a very difficult period for the Ottoman Empire. The state had begun to lose its former power both militarily and economically. Developments in Europe especially affected the Ottoman Empire negatively. European states, which became stronger with the Industrial Revolution, wanted to gain new territories and markets. For this reason, Ottoman lands attracted the attention of the great powers. In addition, because of the idea of nationalism spread by the French Revolution, many rebellions broke out in the Balkans. This situation weakened the Ottoman Empire even more.

During this period, the strongest states in Europe included Russia, Britain, France, and Austria. All of these states wanted to gain political and economic interests over the Ottoman Empire. Russia in particular posed a major threat to the Ottoman Empire because it wanted to reach warm seas and control the Straits.

The Ottoman Empire realized that it could not struggle against these powerful states alone. Therefore, it began to implement a policy called the balance policy. The balance policy means trying to survive by gaining the support of one great power against another. In this way, the Ottoman Empire aimed to benefit from the conflicts of interest among European states.



One of the most important examples of this policy was the Crimean War. In this war, Russia wanted to put pressure on the Ottoman Empire. In response, the Ottomans cooperated with Britain and France against Russia. Britain and France also supported the Ottoman Empire because they did not want Russia to become stronger. Thus, the Ottoman Empire tried to preserve its existence by taking advantage of the rivalry among the great powers.

The Ottoman Empire sometimes established close relations with Western states and sometimes with Russia. For example, through the Treaty of Hünkâr İskelesi,

it gained Russia's support. This shows that the Ottoman Empire could form close relations with different states according to its interests.

As a result, in the 19th century the Ottoman Empire tried to survive by implementing the balance policy against the great powers. Thanks to this policy, the collapse of the state was delayed for a while. However, in the long term, the Ottoman Empire became increasingly dependent on European states and could not regain its former strength. In other words, the balance policy could not completely save the Ottoman Empire; it only delayed the process of collapse.

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Climate Concerns Grow Ahead of the 2026 FIFA World Cup

Climate scientists and sports organizations are warning that the 2026 FIFA World Cup could become one of the hottest and most environmentally damaging tournaments in football history. The event, which will be hosted across the United States, Canada, and Mexico, is already attracting criticism over its projected carbon emissions and concerns about dangerous temperatures for players and fans.

A recent climate study found that nearly one quarter of tournament matches may take place in heat conditions exceeding recommended safety thresholds for athletes. Experts say some matches could even require postponement if temperatures rise beyond safe limits. The risks are especially serious in cities expected to experience extreme summer heat during June and July. Scientists use a measurement called Wet Bulb Globe Temperature, which combines heat, humidity, sunlight, and wind to estimate physical stress on the human body. According to researchers, several World Cup host cities may regularly reach levels that significantly increase the risk of heat exhaustion and dehydration.

Football's governing body, FIFA, has announced plans to introduce hydration breaks, improved cooling systems, and adjusted match schedules. However, critics



argue these measures may not be enough as climate conditions continue to worsen globally. Environmental groups have also accused sporting organizations of prioritizing commercial expansion over sustainability.

The tournament's expanded format is another source of criticism. The 2026 competition will feature 48 teams instead of 32, increasing the number of matches and requiring extensive international travel between host cities. Analysts estimate the event could generate millions of tons of carbon dioxide emissions, largely from air travel and stadium operations.

Climate concerns surrounding the World Cup reflect broader global trends. Around the world, scientists are recording increasingly severe heatwaves, storms, and droughts linked to climate change. South Asia is currently experiencing dangerous temperatures above 46 degrees Celsius, placing pressure on electrical systems and public health services.

Environmental researchers say large international sporting events are becoming examples of the difficult balance between economic activity and environmental responsibility. While such tournaments generate tourism revenue and international attention, they also contribute significantly to global emissions.

At the same time, younger generations are becoming more active in climate innovation. The 2026 Earth Prize competition recently highlighted teenagers from around the world developing solutions ranging from biodegradable plastics to technologies designed to reduce pollution and recycle construction waste. Environmental organizations say these projects demonstrate growing global awareness of sustainability challenges.

As preparations for the World Cup continue, organizers face mounting pressure to address both environmental and public

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health concerns. Experts say the tournament may ultimately become a defining example of how climate change is reshaping global sports and large-scale international events.

Global Energy and Geopolitical Tensions Raise Fears of Economic Instability

Economic uncertainty is growing across international markets as energy prices rise and geopolitical tensions continue affecting global trade. Financial analysts warn that disruptions in major oil shipping routes and ongoing regional conflicts could trigger another wave of inflation and slow economic growth worldwide.



One of the biggest concerns centers on the Strait of Hormuz, a critical shipping route through which a large percentage of the world's oil supply passes. Recent instability in the Middle East has increased fears that interruptions to energy exports could sharply raise fuel prices. Some analysts have warned that crude oil prices could climb dramatically if disruptions continue.



Governments are already responding to the possibility of supply shortages. Several countries have expanded emergency fuel reserves, while others are encouraging reduced imports and energy conservation measures. Economists say prolonged instability could increase transportation costs, raise food prices, and place additional pressure on households already coping with high living expenses.

The uncertainty comes at a time when many global economies are still adjusting to rapid technological changes and post-pandemic financial pressures. Inflation rates remain a major issue in several countries, with central banks continuing to debate whether interest rates should remain high to control prices. Investors are closely monitoring economic reports from Europe, Asia, and North America for signs of slowing growth.

Geopolitical tensions are also influencing global markets in less direct ways. Experts increasingly describe modern economic

competition as connected not only to military power but also to technological leadership, access to energy resources, and control over supply chains. Strategic industries such as semiconductor manufacturing, renewable energy, and artificial intelligence are becoming central to international diplomacy.

Meanwhile, climate change continues to complicate economic planning. Extreme weather events are affecting agriculture, infrastructure, and insurance costs in many regions. Scientists warn that future economic stability will depend partly on how quickly countries adapt to environmental risks while transitioning toward cleaner energy systems.

International organizations have repeatedly warned that many of today's challenges are interconnected. Energy security, climate policy, technological competition, and geopolitical conflicts increasingly influence one another. Analysts at several global forums argue that governments will need stronger